



△ British ships attack Chinese junks, 1841



1819-1901 QUEEN VICTORIA

Victoria was Britain's queen from 1837 to 1901 and Empress of India from 1877. Her nine children with Prince Albert married into Europe's royalty, earning her the name "Grandmother of Europe".

1839-42

THE FIRST OPIUM WAR

For years, Britain had been flooding China with opium, causing an addiction crisis. Tasked with stamping out the illegal trade, Chinese official Lin Zexu confiscated 20,000 chests of opium in Canton in 1839. The British invaded, capturing Canton and, by July 1842, threatened the city of Nanjing.

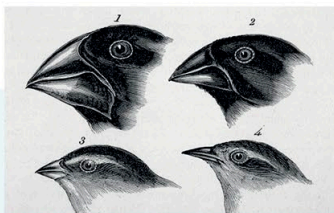
1839 Charles Goodyear
vulcanizes rubber, creating the pliable, waterproof material used in tyres

1839 A cyclone devastates
the port of Coringa, India for the second time, killing 300,000; the city is not rebuilt

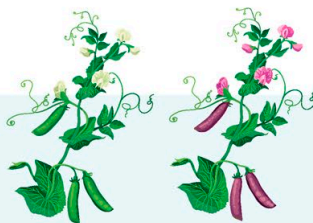
1839

"How can you bear to go further, selling products injurious to others... to fulfill your insatiable desire?"

LIN ZEXU, LETTER TO QUEEN VICTORIA ON THE OPIUM TRADE, 1839



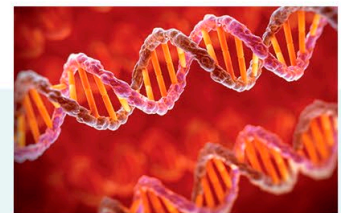
1859 The variety of beak form in finches observed in the Galapagos Islands helps lead Charles Darwin to propose his theory of evolution through natural selection.



1866 Gregor Mendel, an Augustinian friar, studies inheritance in pea plants and discovers that they pass on their characteristics through invisible "factors".



1869 Swiss biologist Friedrich Miescher, identifies "nuclein", now known to be deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA), in blood cells; he suggests it has a role in inheritance.



1953 Scientists Rosalind Franklin, Francis Crick, and James Watson describe the double helix structure of a DNA molecule that suggests how biological information is transmitted.